Business modeling tools:

Business Process Modeling: A visual way to represent how an organization performs work and services.

1. Captures Process
2. Provide visual representation
3. Identify what's needed

Stakeholder: actor

Benefits of Business process modeling

1. Ensure understanding how an organization runs, performs and relates.
2. Identify areas not well understood
3. Identify complex processes.
4. Help with training documentation.

Tools:

1. **Context Diagram:**
   - Provide a visual view
   - Are high level
   - Serve as a checklist
   - Are at-a-glance tools.

   Context Diagram Should fit in One page

   3 fundamentals of context diagram:

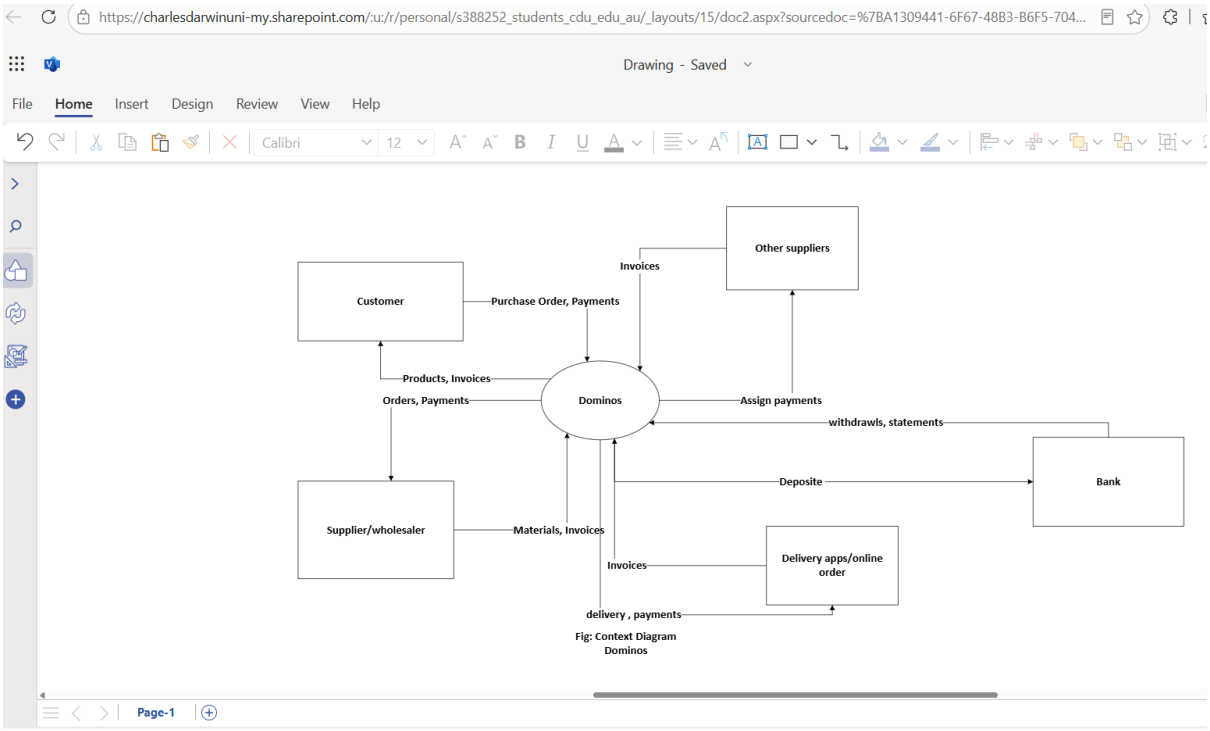
   - Entities
   - Relationships
   - Processes

   Create context diagram

   1. Start with main entity
   2. Add external stakeholders
   3. Connect relationships

   Context diagram does not:

   - Indicate internal functionality
   - Indicate timing or system interactions
   - Capture all relationships



2. Functional flow diagram

They are used for

- Target audience
- Validate stakeholders

This is a step for yourself to review before you step for the next step of the project

Having this diagram helps:

1. Provides a quick overview
2. Are useful for training
3. Create consensus
4. Identify Improvement opportunities
5. Are easy to learn

Always starts with the external entity (stakeholder) from the context diagram based on what functions are required. (example: payment, ordering)

Keep the diagram uncluttered

Steps involved:

1. Focus on single entity
2. Choose the interaction to focus
3. Run high level process workshops.

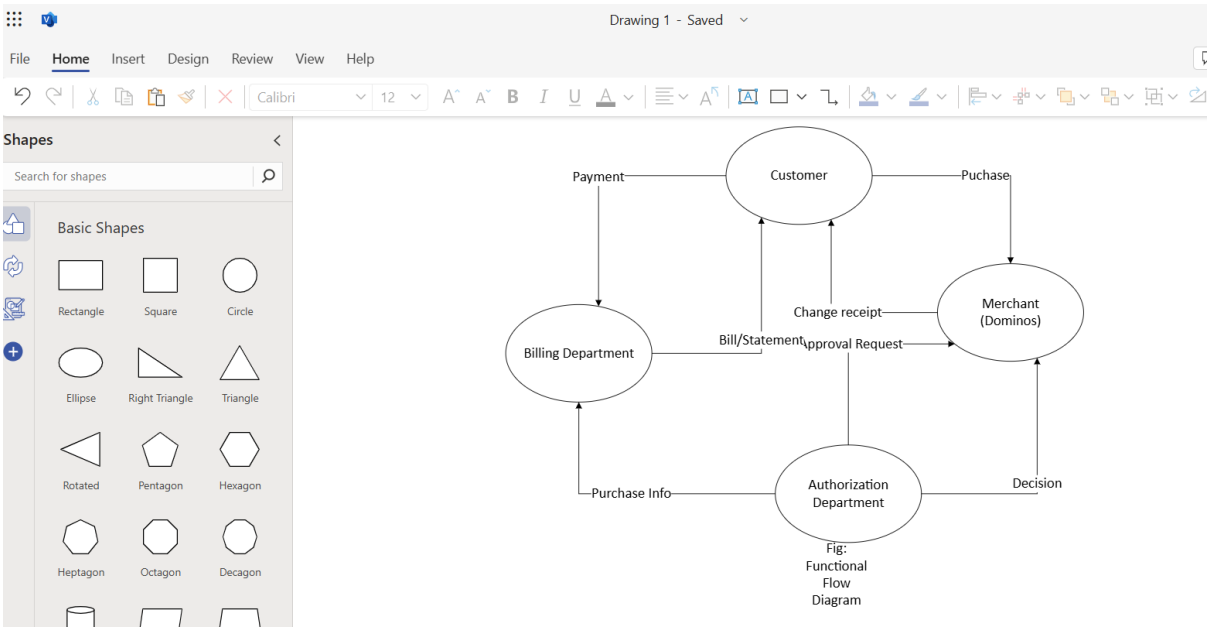


Fig:
Functional
Flow
Diagram

3. **Cross-functional flow diagram (Swimlane/activity diagram)**

It is useful for

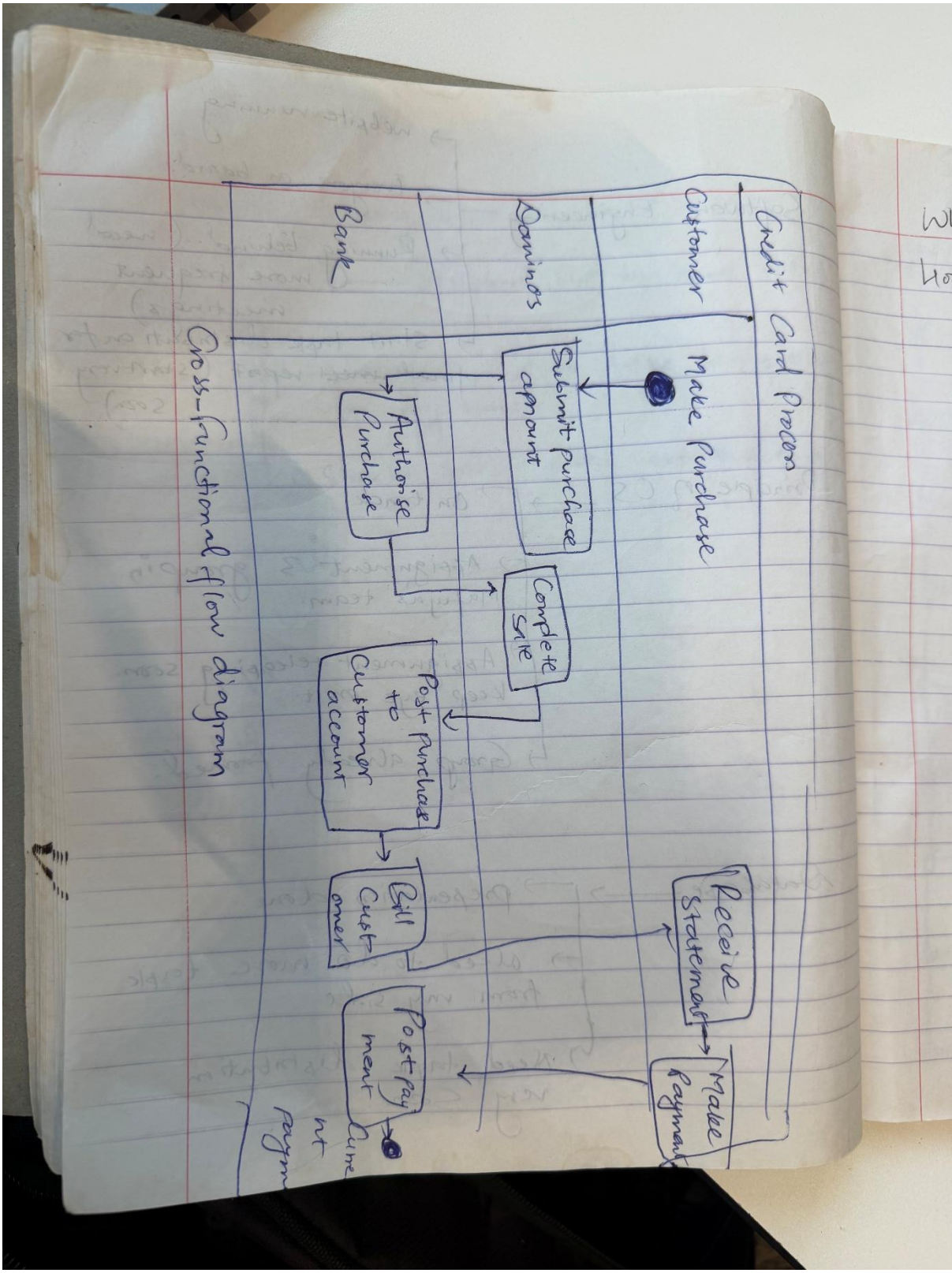
- Identifying and break down complex processes
- Identify unnecessary routing of work
- Help identify inefficiencies

Symbols used

1. Terminator – round (to start and end the process)
2. Rectangle
3. Parallel lines
4. Plus symbol (means that can be expanded for more detail)
5. Daimond- Decision symbol.
6. Arrow(connectors)-indicates direction
7. Activity passes from left to right

What to do be more confident and precise:

1. Plan for interaction, rework and additional discussion
2. Send documentation ahead of time.
3. Ensure version control
4. Authorize stakeholders to validate and sign off.



4. **Flowchart Diagram**

   Purpose of flowchart diagram:

   - K-eep

- R-emove
- A-dd
- C-hange

Impact assessment: See what needs to be done.

Every steps-by-steps detail

Features of flowchart diagrams

1. No interaction with other functional areas
2. Can flow in any direction
3. Use standard flowchart symbols

Symbols used:

1. Round cornered rectangle- Starting and termination
2. Decision Diamond
3. The diagram can flow in any direction as long as and can interpret the flow of the event.

Modeling consistency and standardization

1. **UML** (Unified Modeling Language
2. **BPMN** (Business Process Modeling Notation)

Create Effect Models:

1. Train Modelers
2. Explain model to attendees
3. Check if work has already been done
4. Start with what you know.

Microsoft Visio